

Plan your first family vacation

Even if you book a night or two away at a child-friendly hotel or campsite in the country or near the beach, you all going away together is an exciting family milestone.

If you are expecting even light sun, don't forget to pack sunscreen with a minimum SPF of 30 with UVA and UVB protection, and a sun hat for your baby. Pack some of your baby's favorite instant snacks (such as rice cakes) in resealable sandwich bags for the day. If you are going to the beach, why not take a lightweight pop-up child's tent to give your baby shade—especially at nap time—and a small beach ball, and a bucket and shovel to make sand castles together!



Little chef

As you prepare a meal, put your baby in his high chair so he can watch and copy you. If you make a salad, for example, give him some grated carrot and raisins soaked in water, or couscous and sliced red pepper, in his own plastic bowl with a little spoon for him to mix them together. If you cook a pasta sauce, put a couple of halved cherry tomatoes and grated cheese or cucumber pieces in the bowl for him to “cook” with. Tell him what you are doing and why; he should enjoy copying you and practicing his hand control.

